

DIABLO

Diablo II improves upon Blizzard's original success formula with a multitude of spells, items, weapons, and monsters thrown in the mix. Control one of five diverse, new characters and nurture their skills to their full potential. On the masculine side are the magical, death-dealing Necromancer, the ever-blessed Paladin, and the abnormally strong Barbarian as some of your picks. The feminine selection features the nomadic warrior Amazon and the lethal, yet sultry, Sorceress.

BARBARIAN

The Barbarian is an ace at hand-to-hand combat and boasts of a multitude of skills including the bash, double swing, leap attack and whirlwind. Seek out the best hand-to-hand weapons, get the best armour and fight toe-to-toe with *Diablo II*'s fiercest creatures. Strength: 30, Dexterity: 20, Vitality: 25, Energy: 10

SORCERESS

The Sorceress and her plethora of elemental spells fulfil the role of chief magic user. Perhaps the most difficult class to use, particularly early in the game, without access to high amounts of mana and powerful spells. The Sorceress requires patience and tremendous amounts of mana. Strength: 10, Dexterity: 25, Vitality: 10, Energy: 35

NECROMANCER

The Necromancer doesn't like to get his hands dirty. He summons skeletons, skeleton magi, golems and other creatures in the game. His curses can cause devastating effects on monsters, while his poison and bone spells carry some of the most offensive and defensive powers. Strength: 15, Dexterity: 25, Vitality: 15, Energy: 25

AMAZON

At ease with the spear, bow and javelin, the Amazon specialises in long-range weaponry. Invest in her skill tree, either with the spear or bow, and watch her stomp out monsters. Hit-and-run attacks work well with the Amazon, while you are dishing it out from long range. Strength: 20, Dexterity: 25, Vitality: 20, Energy: 15

5 Diverse Characters to tame the devil. Choose your destiny!

PALADIN

The Paladin is a natural party leader, holy man, and blessed warrior. His offensive and defensive auras affect the entire party (within a particular radius)—certainly a bonus against the tougher monsters you'll face in multiplayer games. The key to playing well with the Paladin is to be quick with your hot keys and use him in tandem with other characters. Strength: 25, Dexterity: 20, Vitality: 25, Energy: 15

SRIRAM SHARMA

Single Player Tips

- If your body is surrounded by hordes of baddies, simply rush in and then rush out. Some of them will follow you, allowing you to pick them off one at a time.
- Don't underestimate enemy AI in *Diablo II*. Use smart tactics and hot keys, and don't just run in blind. Stick and move. This may be one of the best tips for real-time RPGs—always attack once, back away, and attack again. This works for incredibly hard bosses and for enemies

- that have high-attack statistics.
- Use your items. You may die in combat before ever even using them, so it's always better to use your items than to conserve them.
- Communicating with NPCs (non-player characters) can be very helpful on quests. NPCs usually divulge all kinds of information needed for your quest that may help you kill a boss or get a certain item without getting killed.
- Hack and Slash away! Before facing a boss, make certain you are wearing the

- largest belt you can find or purchase. This will allow you to carry more healing potions, and make certain you are fully stocked. The potions are hot keyed, so punch away. Also, the health that you gain from the potion takes a second or two to actually build up. So make sure you punch early!
- Keep all your gold in your stash box and a backup weapon with armour. So if you die, you can simply grab the extra equipment from the stash box and recover it all in one go.